

DAY 76: ANGULAR DIRECTIVES

Structural & Attribute Directives



WHAT ARE DIRECTIVES?

- ◆ Directives are special markers in Angular that modify the behavior or appearance of elements.
- ◆ Types:
 - Structural Directives – Change the DOM layout.
 - Attribute Directives – Change the appearance or behavior of an element.



STRUCTURAL DIRECTIVES

💡 Structural directives modify what gets rendered.

They can add or remove elements from the DOM.

Examples:

- *ngIf – conditionally include a block
- *ngFor – repeat a block for each item
- *ngSwitch – conditionally switch views

📦 Syntax:

```
<div *ngIf="isLoggedIn">Welcome back!</div>
```



ATTRIBUTE DIRECTIVES

🔧 Attribute directives change the look or behavior of an element without changing the DOM structure.

Examples:

- `ngClass` – dynamically add/remove CSS classes
- `ngStyle` – apply inline styles dynamically
- Custom directives (e.g., for highlighting or validation)

📦 Syntax:

```
<p [ngStyle]="{color: 'blue'}">Stylish text</p>
```



CUSTOM DIRECTIVES

🌟 You can also create your own directives!

They're great for encapsulating UI logic or reusable behavior.

Basic setup:

```
@Directive({  
  selector: '[appHighlight]'  
})
```

💡 Use `Renderer2` and `ElementRef` to manipulate elements safely.



BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Use structural directives sparingly for cleaner templates
- ✓ Prefer `[hidden]` over `*ngIf` when you don't want to destroy the DOM
- ✓ Keep custom directives focused and reusable
- ✓ Use `HostListener` and `HostBinding` for interactive behavior



FINAL THOUGHTS

Angular directives = powerful UI control



Mastering both structural and attribute directives helps create clean, efficient, and reactive UIs.

 Got a favorite directive or a use case?

Let's chat in the comments!

